

Starting Over

Dependent prepositions, questions that end in a preposition, and the gerund rule that follows. Marina is moving to a new country, one preposition at a time.

THE STORY

CASE 01

The Decision

Marina had been dreaming of a change for years, but she never imagined it would happen so fast. When the job offer from a design studio in Vancouver arrived, she was excited about the opportunity, but she was also terrified of leaving everything familiar behind. Her friends were surprised she was even considering it. "Are you sure you're capable of starting over in a new country?" her best friend asked. Marina laughed nervously. She wasn't sure of anything, but she was tired of waiting for the right moment. Some decisions, she realized, you just have to believe in.

dream OF

excited ABOUT

terrified OF

capable OF

sure OF

tired OF

believe IN

CASE 02

The Preparation

The weeks before the move were chaotic. Marina was responsible for organizing everything alone: the visa, the flights, the apartment. She spent hours researching, and she quickly got tired of filling out forms. Her mother worried about her going alone, and Marina, though she tried to sound confident, was secretly nervous about the interview she still had to do once she landed. Still, she was looking forward to exploring a new city, even if she was a little afraid of the cold. At night, she dreamed of walking through snow for the first time.

responsible FOR

tired OF

worry ABOUT

nervous ABOUT

look forward TO

afraid OF

dream OF

CASE 03**The Goodbye**

On her last night in São Paulo, Marina's apartment was full of boxes and half-empty suitcases. Her family gathered for dinner, and nobody talked much about the flight the next morning. Her father, who wasn't good at expressing emotion, simply said he was proud of her courage. Her sister complained about the silence in the apartment already, joking that she wasn't used to Marina being so quiet. Marina smiled, but she was thinking about all the small things she would miss: the smell of coffee, the noise of the street, Sunday lunches.

good **AT**proud **OF**complain **ABOUT**think **ABOUT****CASE 04****The Arrival**

Vancouver welcomed Marina with grey skies and cold air, but also with something unexpected: kindness. Her new coworkers were interested in her story, and one of them insisted on showing her around the neighborhood on her first weekend. Marina relied on her broken English at first, but she was surprised by how quickly people adapted to her accent. She still depends on her savings while she waits for her first paycheck, and some nights she still dreams of home. But when she looks out at the mountains, she knows she made the right call. She is finally capable of building the life she always wanted.

interested **IN**insist **ON**rely **ON**adapt **TO**depend **ON**dream **OF**capable **OF****QUESTIONS THAT END IN A PREPOSITION**

In Portuguese, the preposition usually moves to the front of the question. In English, it's the opposite: in everyday conversation, the preposition almost always stays at the end, right where it was attached to the verb or adjective. Moving it to the front isn't wrong, it's just extremely formal, the kind of English you'd read in a legal document, never the kind you'd hear at dinner.

VERY FORMAL (RARE)

About what are you worried?

NATURAL (ALWAYS USE THIS)

What are you worried about?

TRY IT: MARINA'S INTERVIEW**1**1. She is **excited about** the opportunity.**2**2. She is **responsible for** the whole move.

3

3. Her coworkers are **interested in** her story.

4

4. She **relies on** her savings.

PRACTICE LAB · PART A

Fill in the Preposition

Pick the preposition that belongs, then write it in the blank.

1

She is really good _____ solving problems under pressure.

in

for

at

2

He is tired _____ waiting for an answer.

of

in

to

3

I'm interested _____ learning more about UX design.

about

in

for

4

They insisted _____ paying for dinner.

at

on

with

5

We're really looking forward _____ seeing you again.

for

at

to

6

She is proud _____ finishing the marathon.

of

about

in

7

He is responsible _____ managing the whole team.

of

on

for

8

I still believe _____ second chances.

on

in

at

9

My sister complains _____ everything lately.

about

of

for

10

We depend _____ each other more than we admit.

in

at

on

PRACTICE LAB · PART B

Gerund Check

Right after a preposition, the verb always takes the -ING form.

1

She's interested in _____ French.

learning

learn

2

He's afraid of _____ his job.

lose

losing

3

I'm tired of _____ in line.

wait

waiting

4

They insisted on _____ the bill.

paying

pay

5

We're looking forward to _____ you.

see

seeing

6

She's good at _____ puzzles.

solving

solve

7

He's responsible for _____ the project.

managing

manage

8

I dream of _____ the world.

travel

traveling

Ask the Question

Turn the statement into a question. Keep the preposition at the end.

1

Marina is excited about the new job.

2

He is afraid of flying.

3

They are looking forward to the weekend.

4

Marina is thinking about her old apartment.

5

She depends on her parents.

6

He is responsible for the budget.

7

The client is interested in your proposal.

8

She is proud of her promotion.

APPENDIX

Answer Key

PART A · FILL IN THE PREPOSITION

1. at
2. of
3. in
4. on
5. to
6. of
7. for
8. in
9. about
10. on

PART B · GERUND CHECK

1. learning
2. losing
3. waiting
4. paying
5. seeing
6. solving
7. managing
8. traveling

PART C · ASK THE QUESTION

1. What is Marina excited about?
2. What is he afraid of?
3. What are they looking forward to?
4. What is Marina thinking about?
5. Who does she depend on?
6. What is he responsible for?
7. What is the client interested in?
8. What is she proud of?